

Calf Colostrum & Livestock Transport Policy

Beef & Lamb — Red Tractor standards FW.1.1, LT.1, LT.4, LT.7 · Prepared 24 September 2026

DRAFT reflecting standard practice — please confirm the specifics against what actually happens on farm and amend before 1 Oct.

1. Colostrum policy (newborn calves) — RT FW.1.1

- All calves are monitored to ensure they suckle and receive adequate colostrum within the first hours of life.
- [CONFIRM] Target: colostrum within 2 hours of birth, minimum 10% of bodyweight in the first feed, for calves that do not suckle naturally.
- Calves are checked as part of the daily animal inspection routine (see Animal Welfare checklist).
- Any calf showing poor vigour or failure to suckle is flagged for closer monitoring and, if needed, vet advice.

2. Livestock transport welfare — RT LT.1, LT.4

- Trailers/vehicles used to move cattle are checked before each journey for sound floors, secure sides/gates and no sharp edges.
- Animals are visually assessed as fit for the intended journey before loading — lame, sick, heavily pregnant or very young animals are not transported unless the journey is essential (e.g. to a vet) and undertaken with extra care.
- Loading/unloading uses the farm's existing handling facilities (crush systems at Upper Assendon Farm, Shenley, and the mobile crush) to minimise stress and injury risk.
- [CONFIRM] who normally drives/handles livestock transport and whether they have received relevant training.

3. Transporter authorisation — RT LT.7

A Type 1 transporter authorisation is required under EU/retained welfare-in-transport rules for any commercial movement of livestock over 65km. [CONFIRM] whether James holds a Type 1 authorisation, or whether all farm movements are under 65km / handled by a haulier who holds their own authorisation — needs establishing before 1 Oct as this is a Key standard area.